

M00 / LEARNER BOOK

Computer and study foundations

Standalone Zero-to-Job-Ready Data Engineer 2026

8 controlled lessons

A complete learning route

Start with the lesson video. Read the worked explanation beside it, pause to reproduce the example, then solve the supplied task. The books contain your study notes; keep your own work and results as evidence.

Use the protected answers after saving your first attempt. A changed retry shows what you can now do independently. There is no forced timer during learning.

One course. M00-M19. 264 lessons and 50 project phases.

Contents

Tap a topic or use the PDF bookmarks. These numbers are the actual pages in this edition.

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START HERE

How to use this module

Open the matching practice folder from the course root: 01_M00_M03/labs. Work on a copy. Commands printed in a lesson use that module as the working folder unless the lesson names a different location.

Study in lesson order. After the last lesson, use Quick Revision, take the Module Revision Test, then open its separate Protected Answers. Gates are additional assessments at the boundaries shown in the course guide.

This book is written for a beginner. Work through the lessons in order. Read the new words, watch the assigned instructor range, perform the printed example on your laptop, then save an independent attempt before opening the explained review. Ready-made revision is included; you do not need to rewrite the book as notes.

This cumulative package contains M00-M03, G01 and G02. It keeps the completed earlier modules alongside the new SQL modules. The full standalone course continues to M19; the later modules are not delivered as completed books in this batch. There is no fixed time-to-job promise.

Instructor videos open online and use their creators' data. Exact start and stop times are printed with each assigned range. Stop manually at the end: a YouTube start link does not enforce the stop. Published chapter titles, boundaries and runtime were inspected, not complete playback. Read the purpose and any software difference beside the link. A lesson can include written details that its supporting video does not cover; coverage limits remain explicit in WATCH_GUIDE.html.

Study without a Mentor app for now. Keep your own attempts and result evidence using the supplied template. The books contain learner tasks and changed retries; the separate review books contain their answers. The cumulative ZIP includes all required fictional inputs. Never open an answer script before saving your genuine attempt.

Practice workbook: labs/M01/M01_Practice.xlsx. Explained answer workbook: labs/M01/M01_Explained_Answers.xlsx. Their matching explained reviews are in M00_M01_Explained_Reviews.pdf. Attempt G01 after M01.

DE00-01

Files, folders, drives and paths

Watch first

[1. Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners](#)

06:26-10:40

[2. Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners](#)

27:42-29:10

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: None. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners, 06:26-10:40. See familiar folders and the](#) Downloads location. Your user-folder name will differ. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

[Instructor demonstration: Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners, 27:42-29:10. See how a file path identifies](#) its location; copy your own practice-file path. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Find a file again after you close it. This sounds small, but every later data task depends on knowing which input you opened and where you saved the result. You need a Windows computer and a mouse or touchpad. You do not need Excel, SQL or programming yet. A phone is useful for reading beside your computer; do the file practice on the computer.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning Example

File One named item containing information

a shopping list saved as list.txt

Folder A container that groups files and other folders

a folder called practice

Drive A storage location Windows gives a label

the C: drive

Path The directions to a file or folder C:\Users\Ashish\Documents\DE_Study

Parent The folder immediately outside your current folder

DE_Study is the parent of practice

A file is like a particular notebook. A folder is like the shelf holding it. Two shelves can each contain a notebook named list.txt. The name alone does not tell you which one you are holding. A path includes the shelf information. In a Windows path, each backslash separates one level. Your account name might be different from Ashish. Do not type somebody else's full path and expect it to exist.

Follow with me once

Press Windows key + E to open File Explorer, the application for browsing files. Open Documents from the left side. If it is not visible, open Home and find Documents there. A Documents folder might be managed by OneDrive; that is why the actual path on your machine may differ from a printed example.

Right-click an empty area, choose New, then Folder. Name the folder DE_Study. Double-click it to go inside. Create three folders named raw, practice and evidence. Give each a different job:

raw keeps original inputs; practice holds work you can change; evidence holds attempts and explanations you want to keep. Do not put your personal documents into the course raw folder.

Click the address bar above the file list. Copy the displayed full path with Ctrl+C and paste it into a blank Notepad document. Then write: "raw keeps my original; practice holds my working copy." Save the document as folder-map.txt inside evidence. In Save As, check the destination as well as the filename. Close Notepad. Return to evidence and open folder-map.txt. You have proved that the file exists at the location you intended, rather than only remaining open in an application.

What you should see and understand

DE_Study contains three folders. The evidence folder contains folder-map.txt. Opening raw does not show that file, because raw is a different folder. A folder can be empty without being broken. Clicking the Back arrow returns to a previous location; clicking the parent breadcrumb moves one level outward. Those are different actions when you have visited several locations.

Do not memorize C:\Users\Ashish. Learn to obtain your own actual path. Later a program will need this same information to read data. A correct filename in the wrong folder still produces a file-not-found problem.

If your screen differs

If the file seems missing, inspect the address bar before searching the entire computer. You may be in Downloads rather than evidence. If you accidentally created DE_Study inside DE_Study, move your empty practice folders to the intended parent using Cut and Paste; first inspect both locations. If a folder is managed by your school or employer and you cannot create files there, use a location where your account permits personal study files. Do not change system permissions to complete this exercise.

Try it yourself

Inside practice, create a folder named `first_attempt`. In Notepad, create `location.txt` containing the full path of `first_attempt`. Save it there, close it, and reopen it from File Explorer. In your saved attempt file, write the path and explain why `evidence\location.txt` and `practice\first_attempt\location.txt` would be different files.

Changed retry - after your first review

Create a folder called `second_attempt` beside `first_attempt`, not inside it. Save another `location.txt` there containing "second attempt". Reopen each `location.txt` and explain which path leads to which contents.

Revision in your own words

A filename identifies an item within a folder. A full path includes its location. Close and reopen to check a save. Keep original inputs separate from working copies. You may move on when you can find both retry files and explain their locations without guessing.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-01 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-02

File extensions and common data files

Watch first

[1. Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners](#)

10:40-12:57

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-01. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners, 10:40-12:57. Inspect name, type and size](#) columns. This segment does not teach CSV, JSON or extension toggling; the book explains those separately. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Recognize what sort of file you are handling before you open or rename it. First complete DE00-01. You will use Notepad and File Explorer. We will inspect a tiny table as text; you do not need to understand all its business meaning yet.

Words before we use them

Word	Plain meaning	Example
------	---------------	---------

Extension	The ending after the last dot in a filename	
-----------	---	--

		.txt in note.txt
--	--	------------------

Format	The rules used to arrange a file's contents	
--------	---	--

CSV	uses separators between fields	
-----	--------------------------------	--

Plain text	Characters without a workbook's formatting features	
------------	---	--

		a note readable in Notepad
--	--	----------------------------

CSV	A text format commonly used for rows and columns	
-----	--	--

		orders.csv
--	--	------------

XLSX	An Excel workbook format	practice.xlsx
------	--------------------------	---------------

A file extension is a label, not a machine that changes the contents. Renaming a photograph to photo.xlsx does not turn it into a spreadsheet. Applications usually use the extension to decide how to open a file, which is why an incorrect label can cause confusing errors.

Look at a real small file

In Windows 11 File Explorer, use View, Show, File name extensions. In other layouts, look for File name extensions on the View tab. Check that you can now see .txt after folder-map. Extensions are part of the filename; keep them when you rename the main name.

Open Notepad and type the following three lines. Commas separate values within each row. Each new line starts another row.

```
item,quantity  
Notebook,2  
Pen,3
```

Save in practice as tiny-orders.csv. In Notepad's Save As dialog, select All files if needed so it does not add .txt after .csv. Leave a normal text encoding such as UTF-8. UTF-8 is a common way of representing characters as stored bytes; you do not need its internal rules now. Close Notepad. In File Explorer, confirm the exact name is tiny-orders.csv, not tiny-orders.csv.txt. Open it with Notepad using Open with. The commas should still be visible. Opening a CSV in a spreadsheet may display those same values in separate cells. The file did not need to change for two applications to show it differently.

Understand the limits

A CSV does not preserve multiple workbook sheets, colours or chart objects. It also does not provide a workbook's reliable per-cell formatting instructions. An application may guess that 0007 means the number 7 when importing it. We will protect identifiers in M01. XLSX can store sheets, formulas and formatting. JSON is another text data format: it labels values using names, such as {"item":"Pen","quantity":3}. A ZIP contains packaged files; extract it before working. A PDF presents pages for reading. An EXE can run a Windows program, so it is different from a simple reading file.

If something looks wrong

If Windows warns that changing an extension may make a file unusable, cancel unless you deliberately need to correct an incorrect extension and understand the contents. If your CSV opens as text in one column, first inspect its separators and the import settings; do not delete commas at random. If a downloaded file claims to be a document but its real final extension is .exe, do not open it as a lesson document.

Try it yourself

Create stock.csv with a header item,count and two rows: Folder,1 and Marker,2. Reopen it in Notepad. Record its full filename, its three lines and whether it can preserve a chart. Explain why renaming stock.csv to stock.xlsx would not create a workbook.

Changed retry - after your first review

Create a plain text file named names.txt containing Asha and Ravi on separate lines. Make a copy named names-backup.txt. Explain what changes if you rename only the copy to people.txt, and what does not change.

Revision in your own words

Extension: a filename label. Format: the contents' structure. Renaming is not conversion. CSV is useful for simple data exchange; XLSX keeps workbook features. Show extensions and inspect the actual final ending before opening unfamiliar files.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-02 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-03

Download, ZIP, extract, copy, move and rename

Watch first

[1. Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners](#)

17:01-24:25

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-02. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners, 17:01-24:25. Watch the toolbar and](#) copying/moving files. ZIP extraction is taught step by step in the book; it is not covered by this assigned segment. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Make a safe working copy of a course input and prove that you kept the original. Complete the previous two lessons. Use the course package you downloaded; an additional tiny archive, labs/M00/file-practice.zip, is included for this exercise.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning Why it matters

Download Save a remote file on your device

a browser tab is not your local copy

Archive A file that packages other files a ZIP can contain several folders

Extract Unpack an archive into ordinary files

edit the extracted working files

Copy Make another item while keeping the first

suitable for preserving inputs

Move Change an item's location the item leaves its old location

Imagine receiving a sealed parcel containing a notebook. Opening the parcel lets you see the notebook. Writing on a photocopy preserves the notebook. A ZIP is the parcel; extraction unpacks it; copying makes the version you will edit. These are three different actions.

Follow with me once

After downloading this batch, find its ZIP in your browser's Downloads list or File Explorer's Downloads folder. Wait until the download finishes. Right-click the ZIP and choose Extract All. Select a destination you can find again, such as DE_Study\practice. Open the extracted folder. Open the books and workbooks from the extracted folder. The instructor-video links open online.

Inside the extracted batch, open labs, then M00. Copy file-practice.zip into DE_Study\raw. Extract that small archive into a new folder under practice. It contains source-note.txt, orders.csv and a folder named evidence with a blank answer form. Open source-note.txt. It says "Original delivery: 4 orders." Close it.

Select source-note.txt and press Ctrl+C. Open the extracted evidence folder and press Ctrl+V. Rename the copied file attempt-01.txt. Open that copy and add a second line: "I checked the delivery." Save it. Reopen the original source-note.txt and confirm it still has only its original line. Now move attempt-01.txt from evidence into a new folder named completed using Ctrl+X, open completed, then Ctrl+V. It should disappear from evidence and appear in completed.

What the result proves

The archive in raw remains available for a fresh extraction. The extracted source stays unchanged. The edited attempt has a different name and location. Copying creates another item; moving changes where the selected item lives. If a destination already contains a same-named file, pause at the replace dialog and inspect both files. Keeping a new attempt name is safer than guessing which version is disposable.

If something goes wrong

If you cannot save or linked files fail to open, check whether the address bar still shows the ZIP. Extract and open the ordinary folder. If you cannot find a moved file, inspect the destination you selected; a move does not leave a second copy behind. If you overwrote a practice file, preserve what remains under a new name and extract a fresh copy from the untouched archive. That recovery is possible because you kept the source archive.

Try it yourself

Copy the extracted orders.csv into completed as orders-attempt-01.csv. In Notepad change the copied Pen quantity from 3 to 4, then save. Record which file has quantity 3 and which has quantity 4. Keep both. Explain whether renaming the copy also renamed the original.

Changed retry - after your first review

Extract file-practice.zip into another new folder called recovery. Without changing any files, find the original Pen quantity there and explain why it differs from your edited attempt.

Revision in your own words

Download first; extract the complete package; preserve raw; copy before editing; save attempts with distinct names. Copy keeps the source. Move changes its location. Re-extracting an untouched archive can recover a damaged practice input.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-03 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-04

Install only the software this stage needs

Watch first

[1. Python for Beginners Tutorial - VS Code installation segment](#)

11:59-14:20

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-03. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Python for Beginners Tutorial - VS Code installation segment, 11:59-14:20. Watch](#) only how to obtain VS Code. Although the full video teaches Python, Python is not required at M00; stop before Python-extension setup. Stop manually at the listed end. Creator page title and exact chapter boundaries inspected at <https://kevinstratvert.com/2021/06/23/python-for-beginners-tutorial/> ; player runtime and full playback not verified. Only the published installation segment is assigned.

The job of this lesson

Prepare a small, understandable study environment. You need File Explorer, a browser, Notepad and later VS Code and a spreadsheet application. You do not need Docker, Spark, a cloud account or several databases for M00-M01. Complete DE00-03 first so you understand a downloaded installer versus a data file.

Words before we use them

Word	Plain meaning	Example
Application	A program you use for a task	Notepad edits text

Installer A program that sets up another application
a downloaded Windows setup file

Publisher The organisation responsible for software

Microsoft for VS Code

Version An identifier for a software release
record the version your screen shows

Administrator An account with broader system permissions
many personal tools do not need it

Installing more tools does not make a computer more ready for a lesson. Each extra tool adds something else that can update, use memory or produce errors. Keep the browser, PDF reader and one working application open while studying. Close unused applications if your 8 GB computer slows down.

Follow with me once

Check whether VS Code is already installed using the Start menu search. If it opens, use Help, About and record the version in setup-record.txt under evidence. An existing working installation does not need reinstalling merely because a video shows an older interface.

If it is absent, open the official installation page linked below. Use its Windows download and select User setup suitable for your machine. Read the publisher and filename in the browser download. Run the completed installer and follow its displayed steps. User setup normally installs for your account without administrator permissions. If this is a managed computer and

installation is blocked, record the restriction; do not bypass the organisation's controls. After installation, launch VS Code from Start. Opening a blank editor is enough for this lesson. You will create a file next.

For M01, check whether Excel already opens and whether you can edit and save a workbook. Do not buy a subscription just to discover that an existing licence works. Record one of: desktop Excel available; browser Excel available; spreadsheet access still unresolved. This batch's exact click instructions use desktop Excel for Windows. Browser Excel can support much of the early practice, but menus and Power Query availability differ. The written examples remain readable while you resolve access. Mark software-dependent practice as pending until you actually perform it; a video view is not a substitute for the lab.

Your setup record

Write your operating system as displayed in Settings, System, About; your editor and spreadsheet application's names; whether each opens; where your course folder is; and any unresolved error. You do not need to share a product key, account password or serial number. A useful record says "Excel opens but I cannot save this file: [exact message]" rather than "everything is broken."

If installation fails

First check whether the download completed and whether you selected Windows software. Record the exact error and publisher. Try reopening the official instructions before trying another installer. Do not disable antivirus, change PowerShell execution policy or run copied administrator commands to make this introductory course work. If VS Code cannot be installed today, use Notepad for the text exercises and leave the VS Code lesson's completion pending.

Try it yourself

Create setup-record.txt containing the four observations above. Close and reopen it. In setup-record.txt, record the status of your editor and spreadsheet access. Explain the difference between downloading a setup file and confirming that the installed application opens.

Changed retry - after your first review

Close VS Code, then reopen it from Start without opening the installer. Record its version again and compare with your saved setup record. If unavailable, instead write the exact blocker and the next official instruction you need.

Revision in your own words

Use official sources. Distinguish installer, installation and successful launch. Record actual [versions and blockers. Install tools when a lesson needs them. Current installation authority: VS Code on Windows, checked 13 September 2026.](#)

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-04 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-05

VS Code from zero

Watch first

[1. Learn Visual Studio Code in 15 minutes: 2026 Official Beginner Tutorial](#)

00:28-07:58

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-04. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Learn Visual Studio Code in 15 minutes: 2026 Official Beginner Tutorial](#), 00:28-07:58. Observe the editor layout and creating a file. The instructor uses coding examples; create the book's plain text file. AI chat, Git and MCP setup are outside this M00 exercise. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Open your own course folder, edit a text file, save it and find it outside the editor. Complete DE00-04's VS Code setup first. This lesson does not require an extension, an AI assistant, a programming language or a sign-in.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning What to look for

Editor An application for changing text files

the central typing area

Explorer panel VS Code's view of the opened folder

filenames on the left

Tab A label for an open editor document

click to switch files

Unsaved change An edit that is not yet written to the file

often a dot on the tab

Workspace trust A decision about enabling features in a folder

trust only material you understand

Opening one file and opening its containing folder are different. A folder view helps you see the input, working files and evidence together. The editor does not move those files into itself; it displays files that still live on your drive.

Follow with me once

Launch VS Code. Use File, Open Folder. Choose the DE_Study folder you created, then Select Folder. If a trust question appears, consider what this folder contains. For the files you personally created in these exercises, you know the contents. For an unfamiliar downloaded code project, keep it restricted until you understand it. Do not learn the habit of approving every trust prompt automatically.

In the Explorer panel expand evidence and select folder-map.txt. You should see the text from DE00-01. Add a new line: "Opened my study folder in VS Code." Press Ctrl+S. A dot on an ordinary unsaved tab should clear after saving, although some interfaces use different indicators. Close the file's tab, then open it again from the Explorer panel. Check that the new line remains.

Use File, New Text File. Type two lines: "Lesson: DE00-05" and "Editor changes files on my drive." Press Ctrl+Shift+S or use File, Save As. Save as editor-check.txt inside evidence. Check that you selected evidence, because a new untitled file has no permanent location yet. Open Windows File Explorer independently, visit evidence and open editor-check.txt in Notepad. Both applications should show the same saved text.

Understand what happened

Before saving, your new text might exist only in the editor's working state. After saving, another application can read it from the file. Reopening from File Explorer confirms the location and contents. A separate study record describes your attempt and references its evidence. Saving that record does not replace saving the actual file you edited.

You may see suggestions, extension recommendations or chat panels. None is required here. Close a distracting side panel using its close button, or simply return to the file tab. Do not install a Python extension for a lesson that only edits a text note.

If something goes wrong

If the left panel shows the wrong folder, use File, Open Folder and select DE_Study again. If your changes disappear in Notepad, return to the editor and save, then reopen the file; compare both paths if necessary. If a file is read-only, save a working copy inside your personal practice folder and preserve the original. Do not change permissions on system directories.

Try it yourself

Create evidence\editor-attempt.txt with three lines: your lesson ID; your real course-folder path; and one sentence distinguishing an editor from a folder. Save, close and reopen it in both VS Code and Notepad. Record the evidence path in your saved attempt file.

Changed retry - after your first review

Make a copy named editor-retry.txt. Change only its final sentence to "This is my changed retry." Open the original and copy to confirm that the original still has your first explanation.

Revision in your own words

Open the containing folder; inspect the actual filename; save; close; reopen. VS Code edits files that remain on your drive. New text needs a filename and destination. You can study these fundamentals without extensions or AI-generated code.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-05 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-06

Terminal fundamentals

Watch first

[1. Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell](#)

02:40-03:40

[2. Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell](#)

06:30-08:10

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-05. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell, 02:40-03:40. See](#) how to open PowerShell. Stop before the administrator section: the book's navigation exercises use an ordinary window. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, stable player runtime and YouTube-displayed chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

[Instructor demonstration: Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell, 06:30-08:10. Meet](#) named commands. Our exact Get-Location, Get-ChildItem and Set-Location sequence is printed in the book; this video segment is orientation. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, stable player runtime and YouTube-displayed chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Ask Windows where you are, list a folder and navigate to a child folder using three readable commands. Complete the folder lessons first. Here we use Windows PowerShell, not Command Prompt or a Linux shell. Different shells can use different commands; do not mix them without checking.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning Example

Terminal A window for typing instructions and reading responses

Windows Terminal

Shell The program that interprets those instructions

PowerShell

Command One instruction to the shell Get-Location

Current folder The location relative paths start from
your open practice folder

Argument Extra information given to a command

a path after -LiteralPath

A terminal is another way to work with the same filesystem. Clicking a folder in File Explorer changes your browsing location; Set-Location changes the shell's location. Neither action moves the actual files. The word Location in these commands means the place you are currently looking from.

Follow with me once

Open PowerShell from the Start menu. A prompt often begins with PS and ends with >. Do not type the displayed prompt; type only the command below and press Enter.

```
Get-Location
```

The response includes a Path heading and your current location. It might be your user folder. Your result need not match a screenshot. Now open DE_Study in File Explorer, click the address bar and copy its full path. In PowerShell type Set-Location -LiteralPath followed by that path in single quotes. For example, only if this is your real path:

```
Set-Location -LiteralPath 'C:\Users\Ashish\Documents\DE_Study'  
Get-Location  
Get-ChildItem
```

Run one line at a time. Set-Location means change the shell's current location. -LiteralPath asks it to use the path literally. The quoted text is one argument, which matters when folder names contain spaces. Get-Location checks the result. Get-ChildItem lists the contents. You should recognise raw, practice and evidence from File Explorer, even though PowerShell also shows columns such as Mode and LastWriteTime.

Now run Set-Location -LiteralPath '.\practice', then Get-Location. A dot means the current folder; .\practice therefore means the practice child of the folder you were in. Run Set-Location -LiteralPath '..' to go back to the parent. Run Get-Location again. The two dots mean parent. These commands navigate; they do not delete or rename anything.

What to compare

The final path should be DE_Study again. Listing it should show the same folder names as File Explorer. An absolute path gives the whole location, often starting with a drive. A relative path needs a starting point. If you are already inside evidence, .\practice means a child of evidence, not the practice folder beside evidence. The same relative text can therefore succeed or fail depending on your current folder.

If a command fails

Read the exact message and run Get-Location. "Cannot find path" often means a misspelling or an unexpected current location. Copy your real path from File Explorer instead of guessing a username. If Get-Location is "not recognized", check that you opened PowerShell. Do not install software or change execution policy to repair a misspelled folder path. These commands do not need a script file or administrator access.

Try it yourself

From DE_Study, navigate to evidence using a relative path, list its contents, then return to DE_Study. Record the three commands, the final path and one existing filename you saw. Explain why the relative path depends on your starting folder.

Changed retry - after your first review

From DE_Study, navigate directly to practice\first_attempt using one relative path, then use an absolute path copied from File Explorer to return to evidence. Record the ending location.

Revision in your own words

Get-Location: where am I? Get-ChildItem: what is here? Set-Location: look from another folder. Single quotes keep a path together. Dot means here; two dots mean parent. Check location before changing anything else.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-06 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-07

Read errors and repair one cause at a time

Watch first

[1. Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell](#)

10:25-12:55

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-06. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Microsoft PowerShell for Beginners - Video 1 Learn PowerShell, 10:25-12:55.](#) See command help. Apply the book's one-change-at-a-time recovery to your own error; the video does not demonstrate our deliberate missing-folder case. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, stable player runtime and YouTube-displayed chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Turn an error message into a small investigation you can explain. Complete DE00-06. An error is evidence about a failed operation. It is not evidence that you are bad at computers. We will deliberately request a folder that does not exist, without damaging any files.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning In this lesson

Expected result What should happen if the operation works

entering the evidence folder

Actual result What you observed a path error

Reproduce Repeat the same conditions and see the result again

rerun the same command

Hypothesis A possible cause you can test a folder name was misspelled

Retest Repeat the task after a specific repair

use the correct path

Randomly changing five things creates a new problem: even if the task works, you do not know which change mattered. A useful repair changes one relevant thing, then repeats the same check. This is the beginning of debugging, the process of locating and correcting a cause of failure.

Follow with me once

In PowerShell, use your actual absolute path to enter DE_Study. Run Get-Location and Get-ChildItem. Confirm that evidence exists and that evidence does not. Now deliberately run:

```
Set-Location -LiteralPath '.\evidnce'
```

You should get a message saying the path cannot be found. Read the folder spelling in the message. Your current folder should remain DE_Study; check with Get-Location. The failed navigation did not create the missing folder or erase your files.

Create error-01.txt under evidence. Record five things: the command; the starting location; what you expected; the actual message; and your proposed cause. A strong proposed cause is "the command says evidnce, but the folder listing says evidence." It compares two observations. "PowerShell is broken" is much broader and is not supported by this evidence.

Repair only the spelling by running Set-Location -LiteralPath '.\evidence'. Check Get-Location and Get-ChildItem. Add a final line to your error record: "Corrected the folder spelling; the final path ends with evidence and its files are listed." Keep the failed command in the record. It explains why the repair was necessary.

Know what your evidence does and does not show

The successful retest supports this repair for this failure. It does not prove that every future path error has the same cause. Another error might involve a different current folder, unavailable drive or access restriction. Begin with the message you actually have. If the command names a file you did not intend to access, stop and inspect the path before trying again.

A useful help request includes the smallest relevant command and error, plus the expected result and what you already tried. Hide passwords, access tokens and unrelated personal file contents. Do not remove the spelling or path segment that is necessary to understand the problem; you can replace a personal username consistently with YOUR_NAME.

Try it yourself

From DE_Study, try navigating to a missing folder named practce. Save the exact attempt and error. Use the folder listing to identify the likely cause, repair it and record the successful ending path. Explain why reinstalling PowerShell would not be the first useful step.

Changed retry - after your first review

Start inside evidence. Try Set-Location -LiteralPath '.\practice'. If evidence has no practice child, it fails even though practice exists beside evidence. Diagnose this failure, then navigate to the intended practice folder without creating a new one.

Revision in your own words

Record expected versus actual. Inspect the exact command and current location. Propose one cause supported by observations. Change one thing and retest. Preserve the failed attempt and explain the successful repair.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-07 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry

and keep it as a separate attempt.

DE00-08

Study, evidence, attempts and review discipline

Watch first

[1. Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners](#)

18:54-24:25

Pause to connect the demonstration to the example below. Use the printed stop time when a bounded range is given; longer recordings remain available for reference.

Before starting: DE00-07. Video: Instructor watch ranges appear below. Read the vocabulary, perform the guided example and save an independent attempt before review.

[Instructor demonstration: Windows 11 File Explorer for Beginners, 18:54-24:25. Optional refresher on](#) copying files before the backup task. Attempt preservation, study records and evidence discipline are taught in the book. Do not rewatch if copying is already comfortable. Stop manually at the listed end. Public title, creator, runtime and published chapter boundaries inspected; full playback not verified.

The job of this lesson

Use the book, practice files and explained reviews as one study workflow. You have now created, saved, reopened and repaired real files. This lesson explains how to preserve that work and decide what to practise next. You do not need an app to begin. A long study session or completed video does not demonstrate a skill by itself.

Words before we use them

Word Plain meaning Example

Attempt Your answer or work before reading the review

the commands you chose yourself

Evidence Something inspectable supporting your claim

a saved file plus its observed output

Review An explanation to compare with your attempt

why the path failed

Retry A changed task testing the same underlying idea

another starting folder

Revision Returning later to retrieve a skill from memory

explain relative paths tomorrow

Backup A separate copy you can recover from

a copied evidence folder

An attempt can be wrong and still be valuable. It shows what you understood before seeing the explanation. Replacing it with the correct answer removes that information. Keep attempt 1, then add a repair or attempt 2. A retry must change a condition or question enough that you have to think again.

Follow with me once

Open labs/study-record-template.txt in Notepad. Choose Save As and save a copy named DE00-08-attempt-1.txt inside your evidence folder. Keep the template unchanged so it is ready for another lesson. Fill in the lesson ID and date. Session start and end times are optional; choose your own useful session length.

Read the lesson. If an instructor video is assigned, watch the stated range and pause when you need to perform the matching action. A pending video assignment means a suitable instructor segment still needs to be selected; it is not a hidden file you must find. Perform the guided task in your working folder, then close the worked example and try the Practice task.

Write your actual answer in the attempt copy. Include the exact path of the file you produced and what you saw when you reopened it. For example, "I reopened editor-attempt.txt in Notepad. Its first line was DE00-05." This is more useful than "done" because it describes an action and an inspectable result. State any help you used. Save the attempt before opening its matching chapter in the Explained Reviews book.

Compare the reasoning, not only the final number or filename. Keep the first answer unchanged. Below it, add a dated review observation: what matched, what differed and why. Repair the actual file if needed and record the retest. Then save a new template copy as DE00-08-retry-1.txt for the Changed retry. Explain that new result in your own words.

What to keep, and what not to rewrite

The lesson already supplies revision notes. Read those notes when returning to the topic; do not copy the whole explanation into your record. Your record needs only your own answer, observed result, evidence path and any repair. The practical files are part of the work: a workbook shows formulas that a sentence about finishing cannot show.

Suppose you write the path of editor-attempt.txt in a study record. That path tells you where to find the file. It does not contain the external file's text automatically. If you move the course to another computer, preserve both the study record and the actual evidence files. Update the reference if the new location changes.

Make and check a backup

In File Explorer, copy the evidence folder into a separate backup location and give the copy a dated name, such as evidence-backup-2026-09-13. Open that copied folder and reopen one study record and its copied evidence file. Check that both contain what you expect. A same-drive copy can help recover an accidental edit; it cannot protect against failure of that drive. If available, keep another copy on a separate device or storage location you already use.

If an exercise fails, preserve the expected and actual results. For example, if Notepad shows an old line, check whether you saved the edited file and whether both applications opened the same

path. After repair, reopen the file again. The successful retest should address the original failure.

Try it yourself

Save a new study-record copy explaining how a file path differs from a file's contents. Include the real path of editor-attempt.txt. Save and reopen both files. Copy both into a new backup folder and reopen the copies. In your record, state what you checked and whether writing the path alone would preserve the external text file.

Changed retry - after your first review

Save a separate retry record explaining one path error you repaired. Make a new dated backup copy that includes the original attempt and this retry. Keep your earlier backup too. Reopen the new backup and check that both records are present. Explain why the earlier backup cannot contain work created after it was made.

Revision in your own words

Read, watch, do, attempt, review, repair, retry, explain, revisit. Keep original attempts. Use the supplied revision notes. Record practical evidence, not pages of copied theory. Keep actual files as well as their references. M00 is ready when you can locate, edit, save, reopen and repair a file task independently.

Evidence to keep: your attempt, the observed result and its explanation. Save the first attempt before opening DE00-08 in the Explained Reviews book. After review, solve the changed retry and keep it as a separate attempt.